

Three capabilities surface retrieval structurally lacks



Cite

structural receipt

- **SMA**
Each hit is a structural alignment, so the supporting evidence is a citation that entails the answer.

- **VECTOR RAG**
Returns a passage ranked by similarity, with no guarantee it entails the answer.



Abstain

calibrated

- **SMA**
If nothing structurally matches, it withholds the answer.

- **VECTOR RAG**
Similarity is always non-zero — it cannot tell when to stop.



Flag novelty

expectation violation

- **SMA**
A case matching nothing in memory is surfaced as a candidate new entity.

- **VECTOR RAG**
Returns the nearest neighbour and treats the unprecedented as precededented.

Fig. 3 | Structure-mapping gives an agent three trust capabilities surface retrieval cannot. For each capability, why SMA can (teal) and why vector RAG cannot (grey). **Cite**, a hit is a structural alignment that entails the answer, not a similar passage. **Abstain**, no structural match means the system withholds rather than returning a non-zero-similarity neighbour. **Flag novelty**, a case matching nothing in memory is surfaced as new instead of forced onto its nearest neighbour.